3797-A

Executive Order

WHEREAS there are large seepages of petroleum along the Arctic Coast of Alaska and conditions favorable to the occurrence of valuable petroleum fields on the Arctic Coast and,

WHEREAS the present laws designed to promote development seem imperfectly applicable in the region because of its distance, difficulties, and large expense of development and,

WHEREAS the future supply of oil for the Navy is at all times a matter of national concern,

NOW, THEREFORE, I, WARREN G. HARDING, President of the United States of America, by virtue of the power in me vested by the laws of the United States, do hereby set apart as a Naval Petroleum Reserve all of the public lands within the following described area not now covered by valid entry, lease or application:

Commencing at the most northwestern extremity of the point of land shown on the maps of Alaska as Icy Cape, approximately lat. 70° 21′, long. 161° 46′; thence extending in a true south course to the crest of the range of mountains forming the watershed between the Noatak River and its northern tributaries and the streams flowing into the Arctic Ocean; thence eastward along the crest of this range of mountains to a peak at the head of the northermost of the two eastern forks of Midas Creek (Pl. 1, U.S.G.S., Bull. 536), at approximately lat. 67° 50′, long. 156° 08′; thence in a true north course to a point at the highest high water on the western or right bank of the Colville River; thence following said highest highwater mark downstream along said Colville River and the western bank of the most western slough at its mouth to the highest highwater mark on the Arctic coast. From here, following the highest highwater mark westward to the point of beginning.

The coast line to be followed shall be that of the ocean side of the sandspits and islands forming the barrier reefs and extending across small lagoons from point to point, where such barrier reefs are not over three miles off shore, except in the case of Plover Islands, from Point Tangent to Point Barrow (Pl. 3, U.S.G.S., P.P. 109), long. approximately 154° 50′, where it shall be the highest highwater mark on the outer shore of the islands forming the groups and extending between the most adjacent points of these islands and the sandspits at either end. In cases where the barrier reef is over three miles off shore the boundary shall be the highest highwater mark of the coast of the mainland.

Said lands to be so reserved for six years for classification, examination, and preparation of plans for development and until otherwise ordered by the Congress or the President.

The reservation hereby established shall be for oil and gas only and shall not interfere with the use of the lands or waters within the area indicated for any legal purpose not inconsistent therewith.

WARREN G HARDING

THE WHITE HOUSE,
Feby. 27, 1923.

[No. 3797–A.]

GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE